

Thomas F. Dwyer House
South Fountain Avenue Historic District
29 W. Grand Ave.
Springfield
Clark County
Ohio

HABS No. OH-2449

HABS
OHIO
12-SPRIF
11-

PHOTOGRAPHS

WRITTEN HISTORICAL AND DESCRIPTIVE DATA

Historic American Buildings Survey
National Park Service
Great Lakes Systems Office
Department of the Interior
1709 Jackson St.
Omaha, Nebraska 68102

HABS
OHIO
12-SPRIF
11-

HISTORIC AMERICAN BUILDINGS SURVEY

THOMAS F. DWYER HOUSE HABS No. OH-2449

Location: 29 W. Grand Ave., Springfield, Clark County, Ohio

Significance: This house is significant as an early example of Italianate style working class residential housing stock in the city. It retains its basic form and is distinguished by its bracketed cornice, long and elegant windows and simple L-shaped plan.

Description: The Dwyer House is a long narrow building that is part of a closely spaced cluster of late 19th century houses within the South Fountain Avenue Historic District. The frame walls rise from a low stone foundation and extend up above the second floor. The building has a simple low-pitched hipped roof on its front porch, set in the angle formed by the front and side wings. It has a newer masonry floor and metal porch columns replace original wood columns. Windows are symmetrically arranged on the exterior and have one-over-one wood sash. The exterior is covered with aluminum siding. The most elegant feature of the house is its bracketed cornice, which extends around the front and sides. The rear has a one-story hip-roofed wing that is as wide as the main and side sections of the house. It has a side doorway with wood canopy. The house has a center brick chimney

History: This building was probably constructed by 1880, judging from its styling and materials. In 1895 a permit was taken out to connect this apparently pre-existing house to the city's water system. Thomas F. Dwyer lived here then. He worked as a bench hand, probably at a nearby factory. The city directories from 1915-39 list this as the residence of Thomas and Helen Dwyer. His occupation was the same. It had a variety of occupants in the following years. From 1957-64 this was home to Roger and Virginia Bowers. He worked as a clerk for the Superior Antenna Service. From 1986-94 this was home to Maxine Jones.

Sources: 1895, 1915 and later Springfield city directories. The building stands within the South Fountain Avenue Historic District, which has been listed on the National Register of Historic Places. Copies of information used to make this determination of eligibility for National Register status are at the Springfield Department of Planning and Development and the Ohio Historic Preservation Office.

Historian: Steven McQuillin, preservation consultant to the City of Springfield, 1997